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# INDIAN STRATEGIES ON CHINA

## Past, present, and future

*Jo Inge Bekkevold and S. Kalyanaraman*

China has represented a persistent security concern for India from the late 1940s. Still, India has on several occasions adjusted its policies towards managing China. In the first few years after the People's Republic of China was established in 1949, India sought to forge a cooperative relationship with China and in the process underbalanced against it. Following the 1962 War, India's policy on China undertook a dramatic turn by resorting to full-fledged balancing in the form of both a military build-up and reaching out to alliance partners, first the United States and then from the early 1970s through the Treaty of Friendship with the Soviet Union. The collapse of the Soviet Union and the end of the Cold War brought upon India another geopolitical shock, and it adopted a policy on China consisting of a mix of cooperation through greater economic linkages and coordination of diplomatic positions in multilateral institutions while at the same time confronting China on the border issue and maintaining military deterrence.